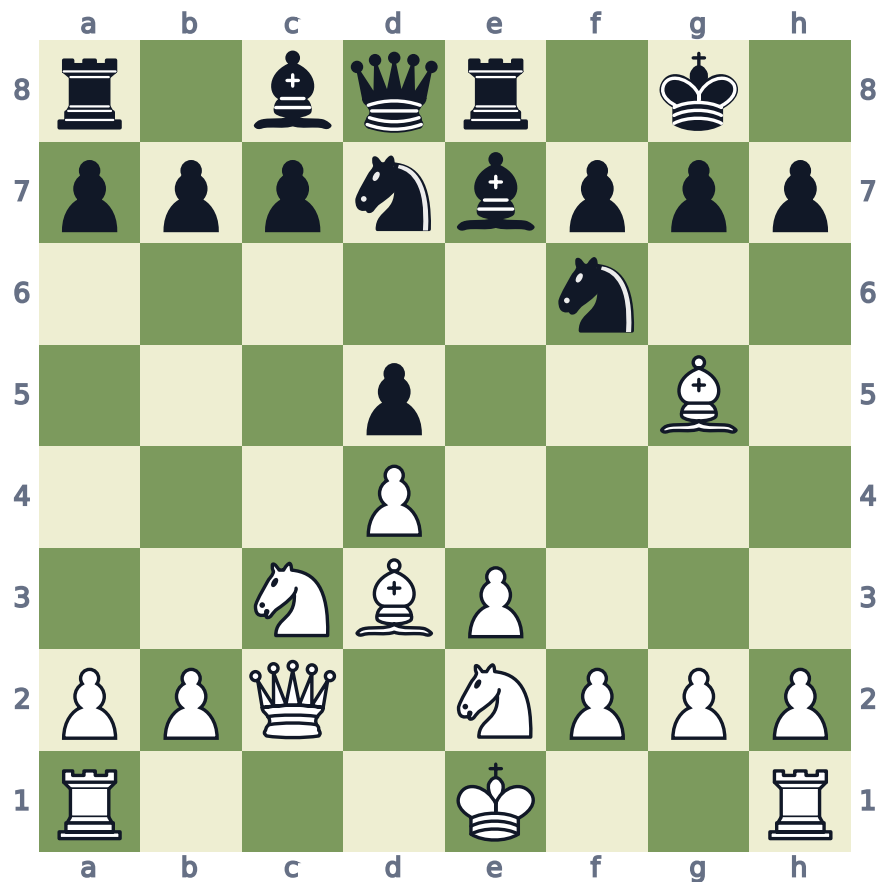


1.d4 Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas

Carlsbad, isolated queen pawn, hanging pawns, Slav, Catalan, Indian, and Benoni structures



Connect opening moves to the middlegame structures they create, with plan maps for both sides and position-based training.

30 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Connect opening moves to the middlegame structures they create, with plan maps for both sides and position-based training.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 30 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Pawn structure determines files, outposts, and likely breaks.

PRINCIPLE 2

A plan is a way to improve the position, not a substitute for tactics.

PRINCIPLE 3

The same structure can arise from different openings.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Every pawn break changes squares as well as files.

PRINCIPLE 5

The worst-placed piece often reveals the next useful move.

PRINCIPLE 6

Structure knowledge reduces memory load because it explains future moves.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRUCTURE CHECKLIST

Read the pawns before choosing a plan

1. CENTER

Is it open, closed, fixed, mobile, or under immediate tension?

2. PAWN BREAKS

Which pawn move can change the structure, and what squares will it abandon?

3. FILES

Which files will open after the likely exchanges?

4. OUTPOSTS

Which squares cannot be challenged by an enemy pawn?

5. BAD PIECE

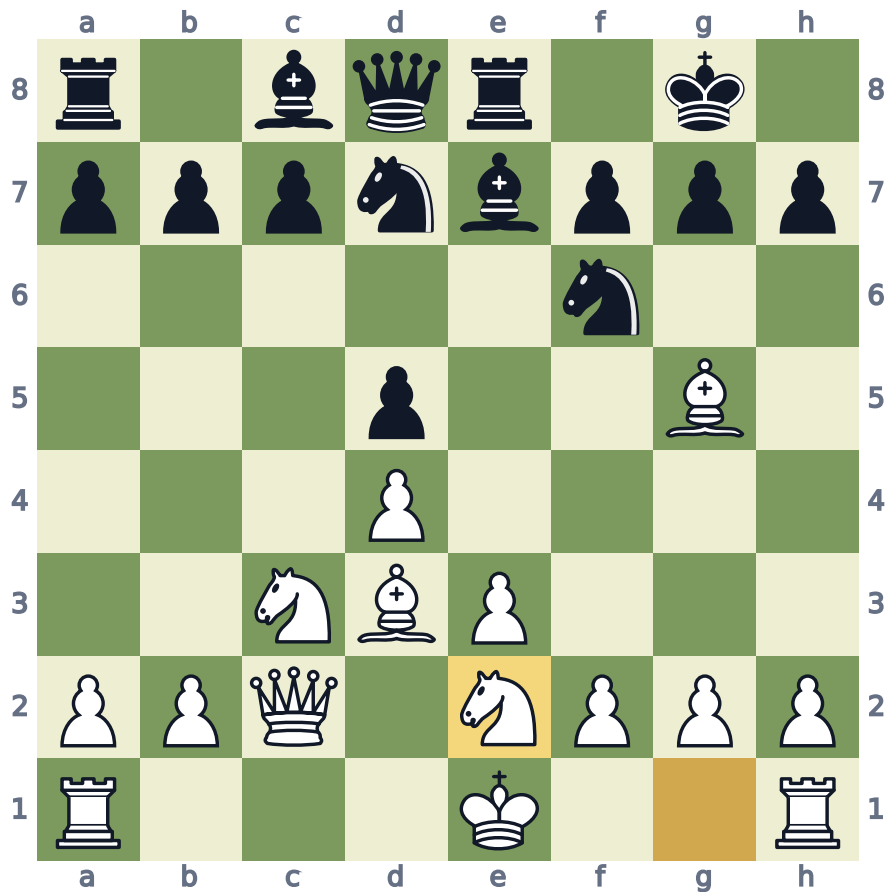
Which piece has the fewest useful squares, and what pawn move would improve it?

6. WING

Which side of the board does the pawn chain point toward?

STRUCTURE 01 OF 30

Exchange QGD core



WHITE'S PLAN

Build toward f3 and e4 or a queenside minority attack.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Do not play e4 until d4 and the king are secure.

ENGINE SAMPLE

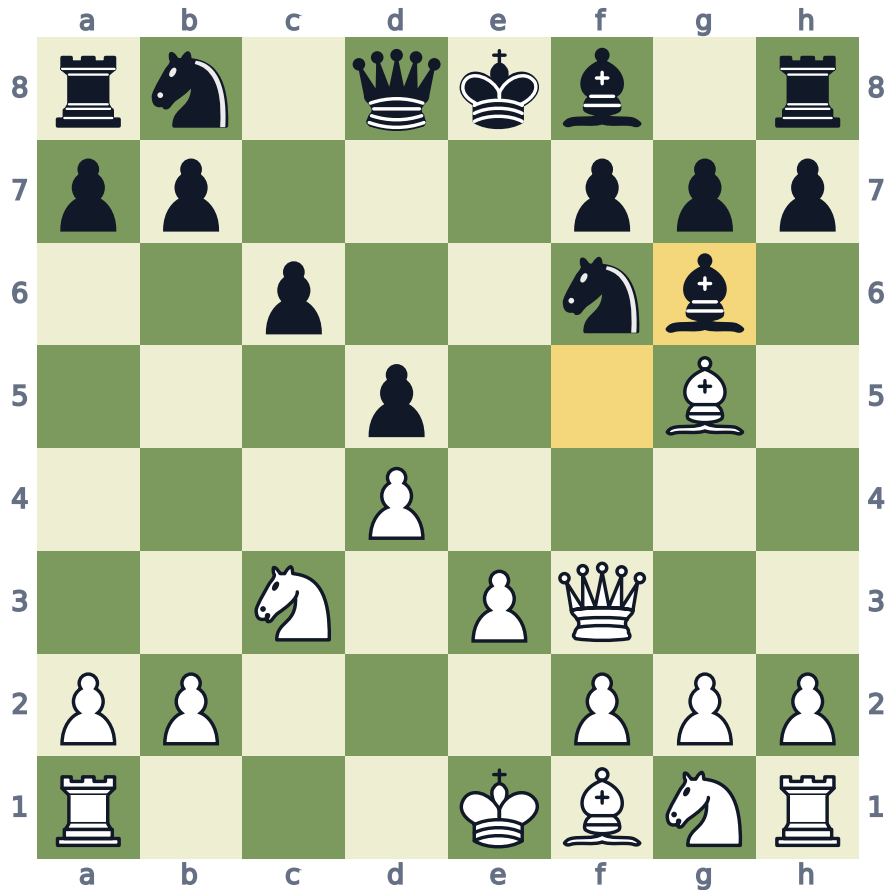
1. c6 O-O 2. h6 Bh4 3. Nh5 Bxe7 4. Qxe7 Rae1 5. Ndf6 h3 (+0.22 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

cx d5 plus ...exd5 creates the Carlsbad structure.

STRUCTURE 02 OF 30

Development before expansion



WHITE'S PLAN

Prevent a free ...Bf5 or use queen pressure to question the bishop.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Qf3 can be met by development with tempo if played carelessly.

ENGINE SAMPLE

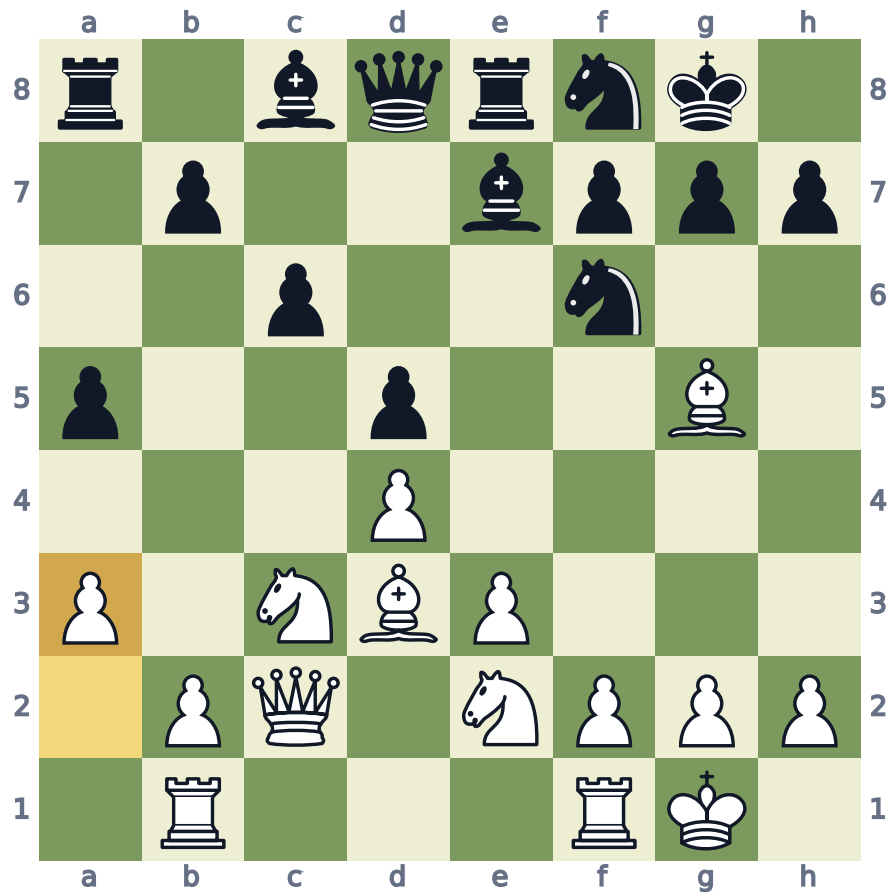
1. Bxf6 Qxf6 2. Qxf6 gxf6 3. h4 h5 4. Rc1 Nd7 5. Nh3 Bd6 (+0.38 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Ask whether Black's c8 bishop can leave before ...Nbd7.

STRUCTURE 03 OF 30

Minority attack setup



WHITE'S PLAN

Prepare b4-b5 to create a backward c6-pawn.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Queenside play must not ignore Black's kingside or central break.

ENGINE SAMPLE

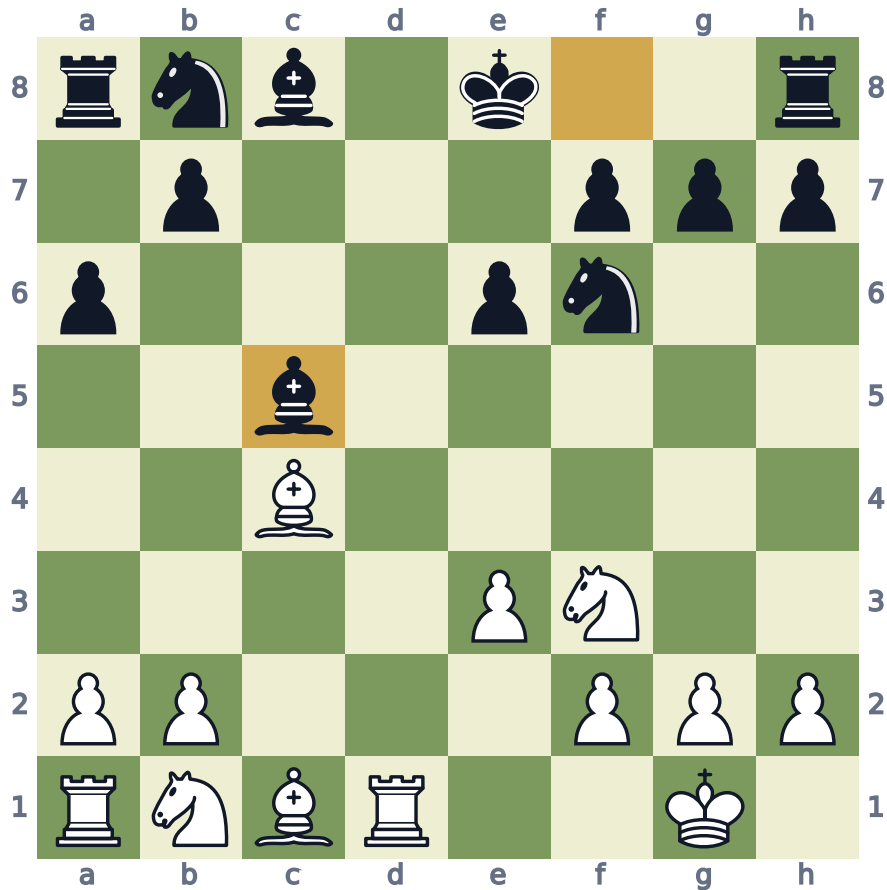
1. g6 Nf4 2. Ne6 Nxe6 3. Bxe6 Rfe1 4. Nh5 Bxe7 5. Rxe7 Na4 (+0.18 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

When Black has a6-b7-c6 versus a2-b2, b4-b5 is the structural lever.

STRUCTURE 04 OF 30

QGA classical recovery

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Recover c4 through development and accept a clean active endgame.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Do not fear queen trades when development and structure are healthy.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Be2 O-O 2. Ne5 Nbd7 3. Nc4 Nb6 4. Na5 Nbd5 5. Nd2 b6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Bxc4 plus O-O is the reliable recovery sequence.

STRUCTURE 05 OF 30

QGA ...b5 expansion



WHITE'S PLAN

Undermine the pawn chain rather than chase its front pawn.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Opening the a-file can expose the rook if geometry is ignored.

ENGINE SAMPLE

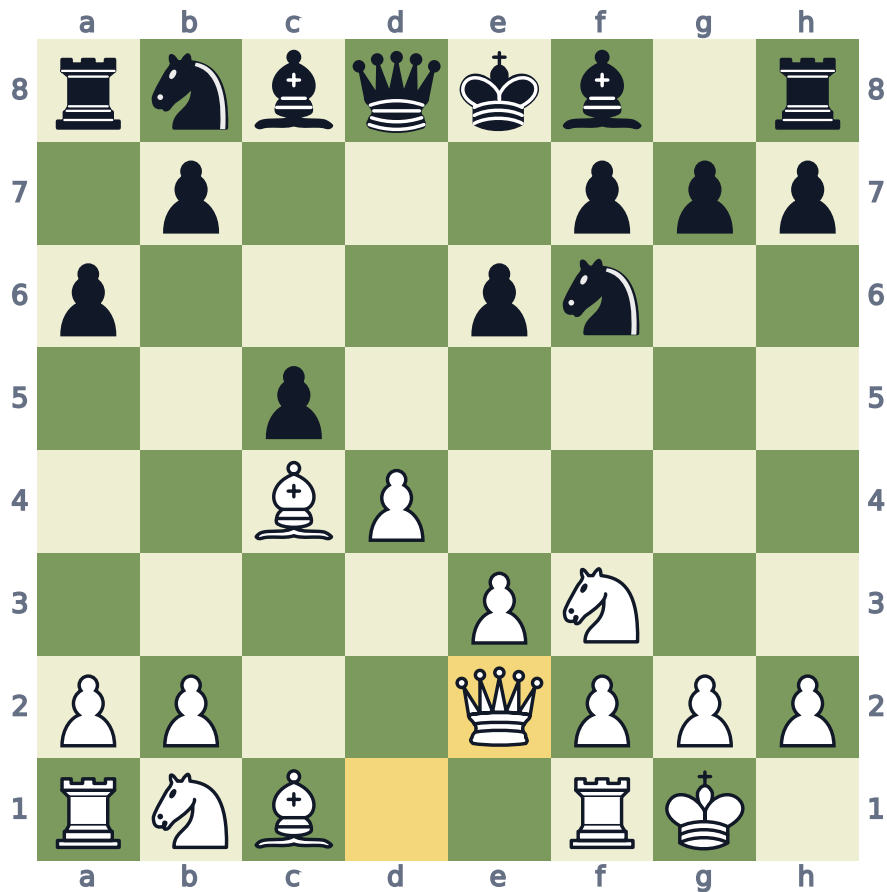
1. e6 bxc4 2. bxc4 Bxc4 (+0.31 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Attack the base of ...b5 with a4 or b3.

STRUCTURE 06 OF 30

QGA central strike

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Complete development and be ready for dxc5 or e4.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

An automatic dxc5 can release Black's bishop with tempo.

ENGINE SAMPLE

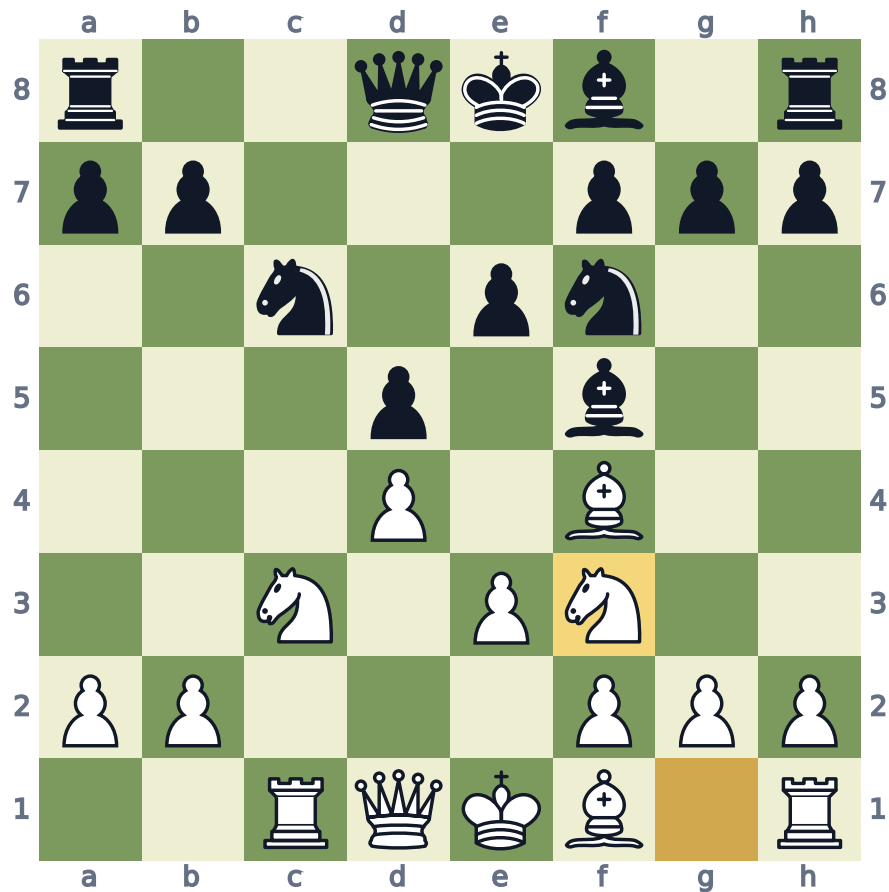
1. b5 Bd3 2. Nbd7 a4 3. c4 Bc2 4. Bb7 e4 5. Be7 Nc3 (+0.30 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When Black plays ...c5, decide whether tension or exchange favors development.

STRUCTURE 07 OF 30

Exchange Slav



WHITE'S PLAN

Use active piece placement and pressure the c-file in a symmetrical structure.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Symmetry does not mean a draw; careless development can still concede initiative.

ENGINE SAMPLE

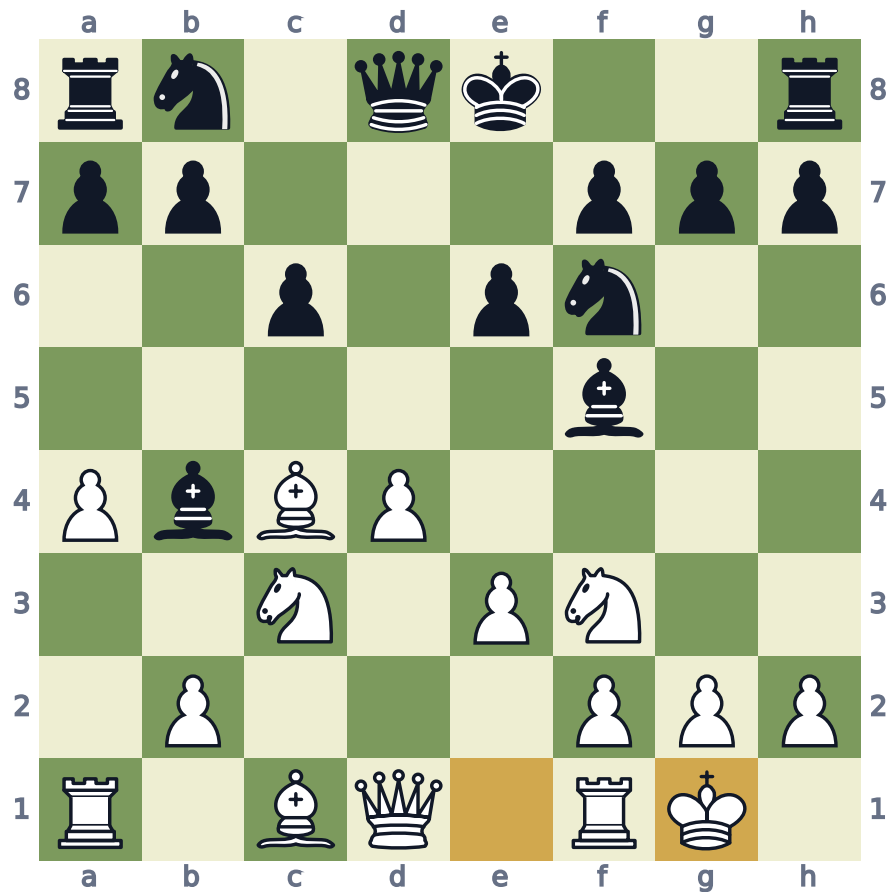
1. Bb4 Bb5 2. Ne4 O-O 3. Bxc3 Bxc6+ 4. bxc6 bxc3 5. g5 Bg3 (+0.21 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Bf4, Rc1, and Nf3 create useful pressure without structural risk.

STRUCTURE 08 OF 30

Main Slav recovery



WHITE'S PLAN

Limit ...b5, recover c4, and castle before central expansion.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

e4 can be met by ...b5 or ...Bb4 if played too early.

ENGINE SAMPLE

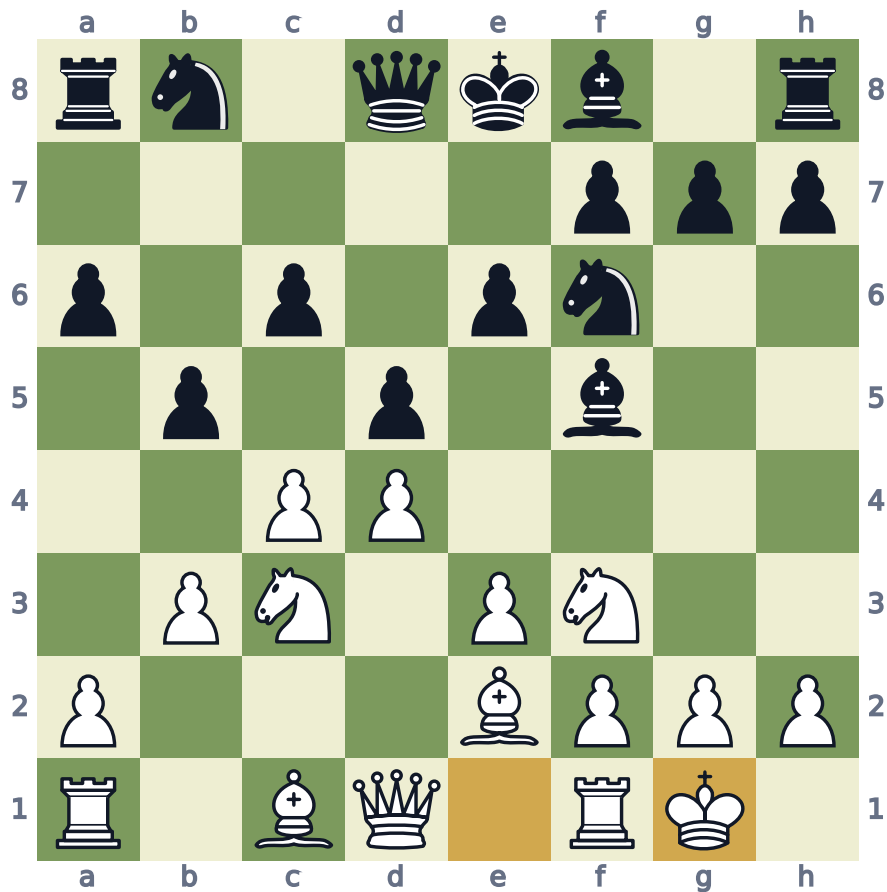
1. O-O Nh4 2. Nbd7 f3 3. Bg6 Qe2 4. c5 Nxc6 5. hxg6 Rd1 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

a4 is the key anti-expansion move after ...dxc4.

STRUCTURE 09 OF 30

Slav ...a6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Challenge the queenside chain with b3 and complete development.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

An automatic a4 can give Black a protected b4 square.

ENGINE SAMPLE

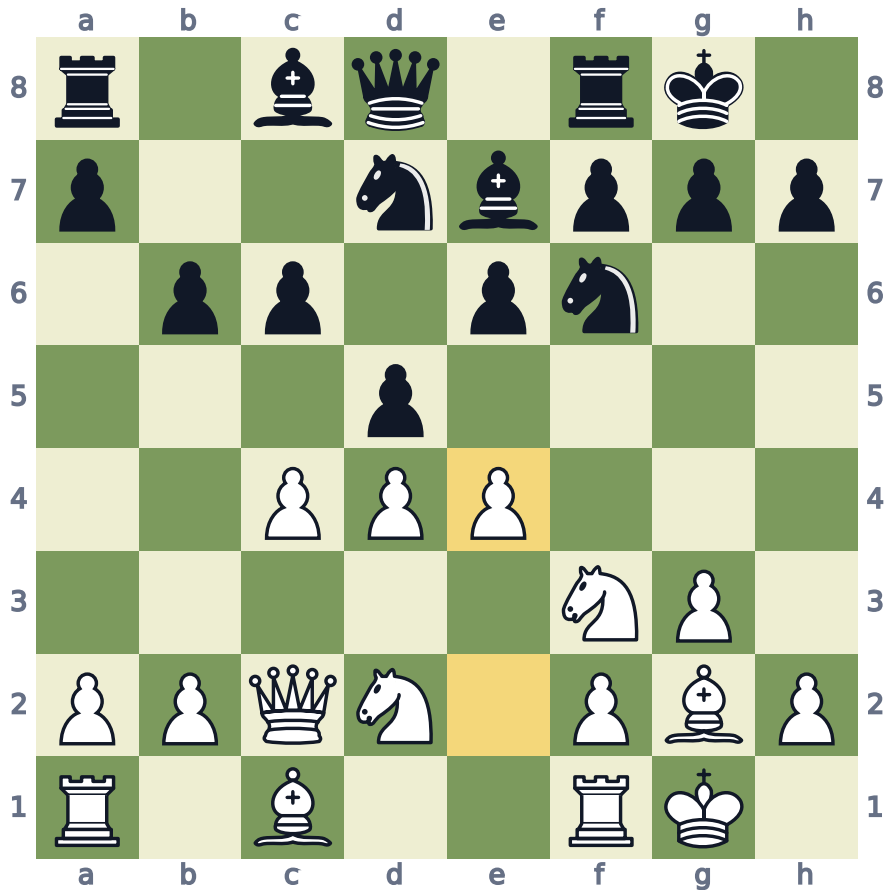
1. Bd6 Nh4 2. O-O c5 3. Bc7 Nxf5 4. exf5 a4 5. b4 Na2 (+0.30 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against ...a6 and ...b5, attack the chain's base and watch b4.

STRUCTURE 10 OF 30

Closed Catalan core



WHITE'S PLAN

Complete the fianchetto and prepare e4 while the center remains closed.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

e4 without enough support can lose d4 or permit ...dxe4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

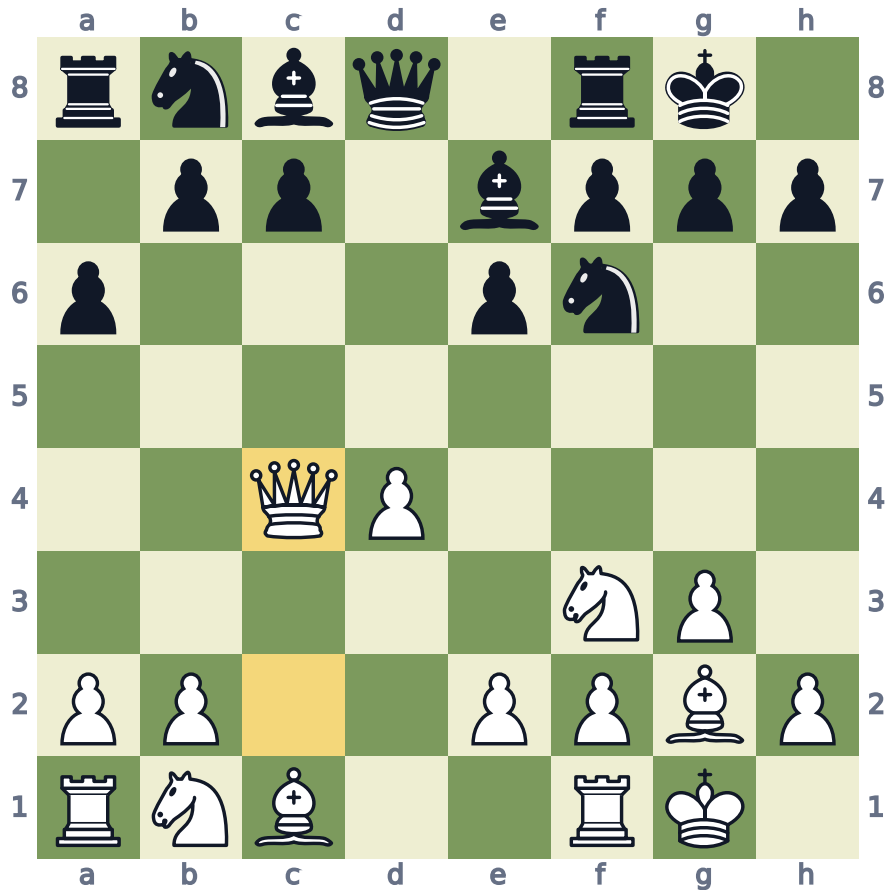
1. Bb7 e5 2. Ne8 cxd5 3. exd5 Re1 4. Nc7 Nf1 5. Ne6 (+0.60 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Closed center plus g2 bishop means prepare the central release.

STRUCTURE 11 OF 30

Open Catalan recovery



WHITE'S PLAN

Recover c4 while preserving the bishop's diagonal and development lead.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The queen on c4 can be chased by ...b5.

ENGINE SAMPLE

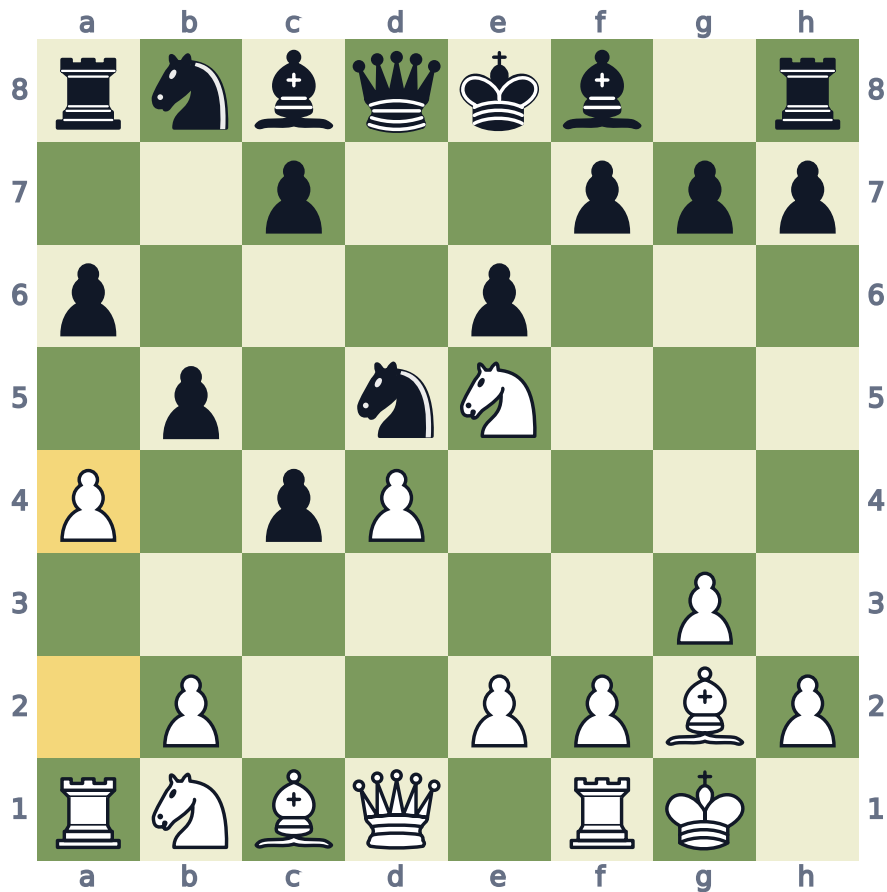
1. b5 Qc2 2. Bb7 Bf4 3. Nc6 Nc3 4. Nb4 Qb3 5. c5 dxc5 (+0.11 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

Qc2 eyes c4 and h7 while avoiding early exposure.

STRUCTURE 12 OF 30

Open Catalan with Qa4+



WHITE'S PLAN

Use the center and long diagonal to undermine Black's pawn chain.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

A premature axb5 can open useful files for Black.

ENGINE SAMPLE

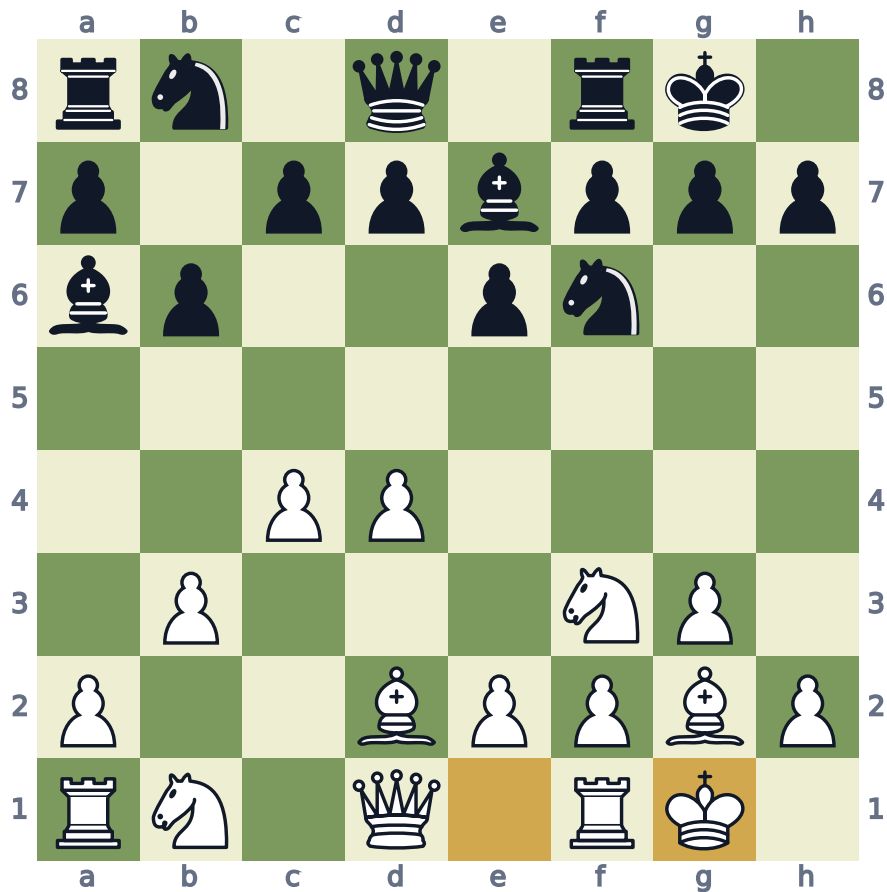
1. Bb7 b3 2. cxb3 axb5 3. Be7 Qxb3 (+0.78 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When Black holds c4 with ...b5, attack the chain with a4 and Ne5.

STRUCTURE 13 OF 30

Queen's Indian ...Ba6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Use b3 to protect c4 and force the bishop to declare its purpose.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

b3 weakens dark squares if White later loses the g2 bishop.

ENGINE SAMPLE

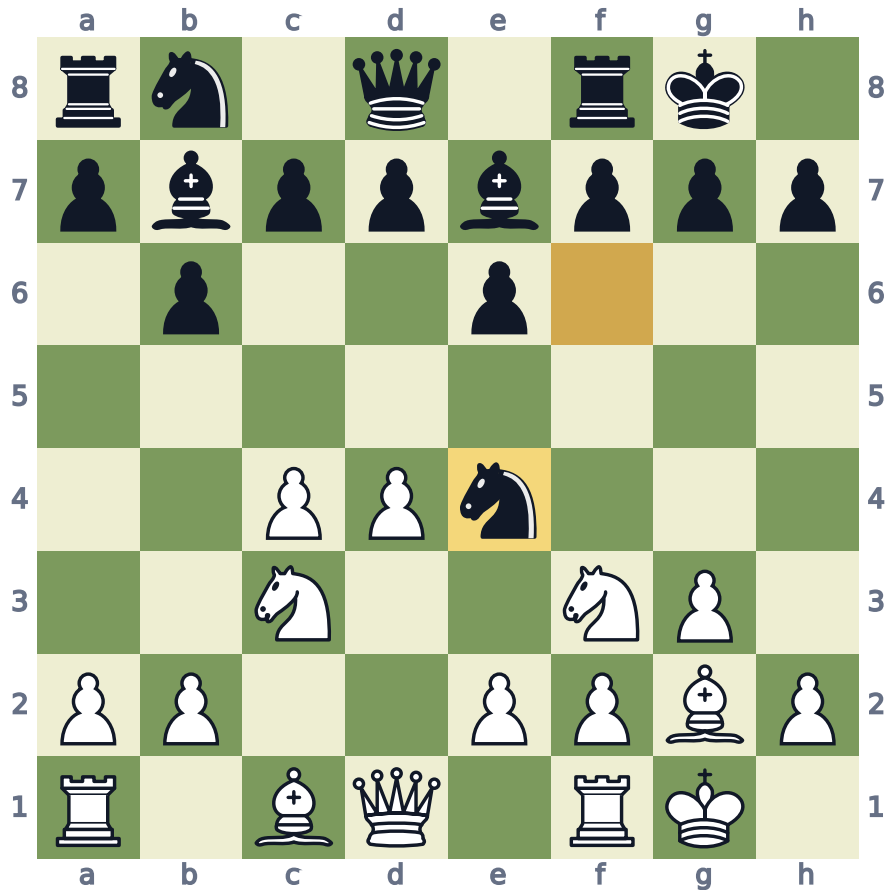
1. c6 Qc2 2. d5 Ne5 3. dxc4 bxc4 4. Qxd4 Bc3 5. Qd6 Nd2 (+0.38 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...Ba6 attacks c4 and interferes with natural queenside development.

STRUCTURE 14 OF 30

Queen's Indian ...Bb7

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Finish development and test the centralized knight before occupying e4.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Careless d5 can leave c5 and e5 weak.

ENGINE SAMPLE

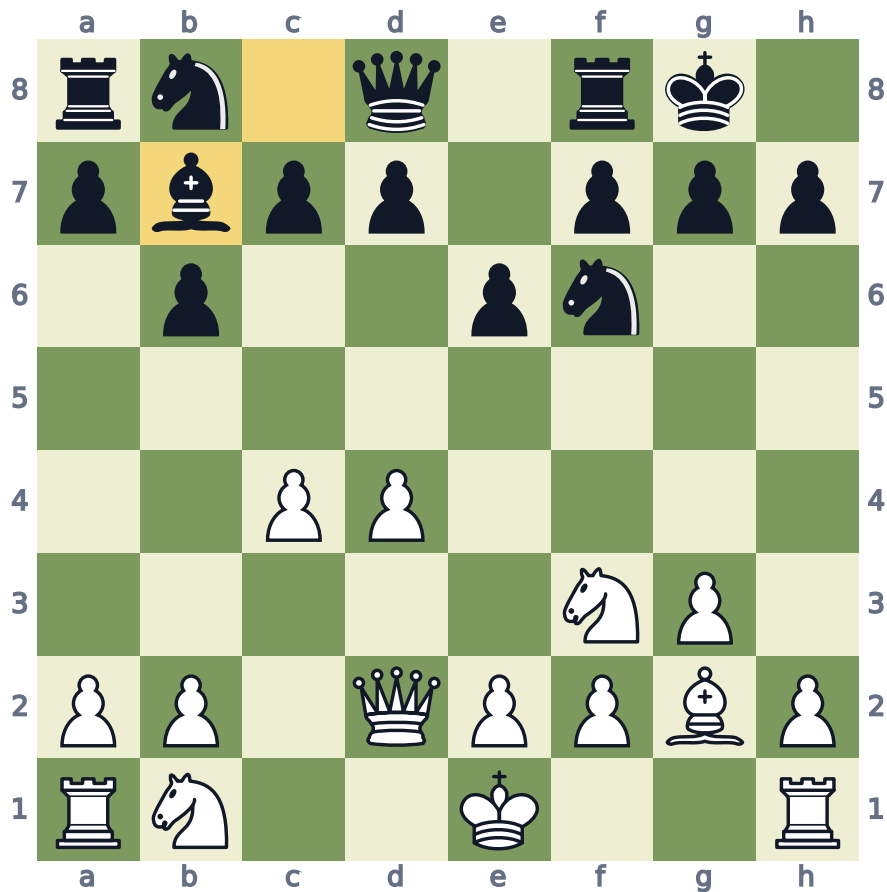
1. Bd2 d5 2. cxd5 exd5 3. Qc2 Nd7 4. Rfd1 Rc8 5. Ne5
(+0.41 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

The b7 bishop and e4 knight form Black's central control team.

STRUCTURE 15 OF 30

Queen's Indian ...Bb4+

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Accept a useful queen placement and retain the bishop pair.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The queen on d2 can block the b1 knight and invite ...Ne4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

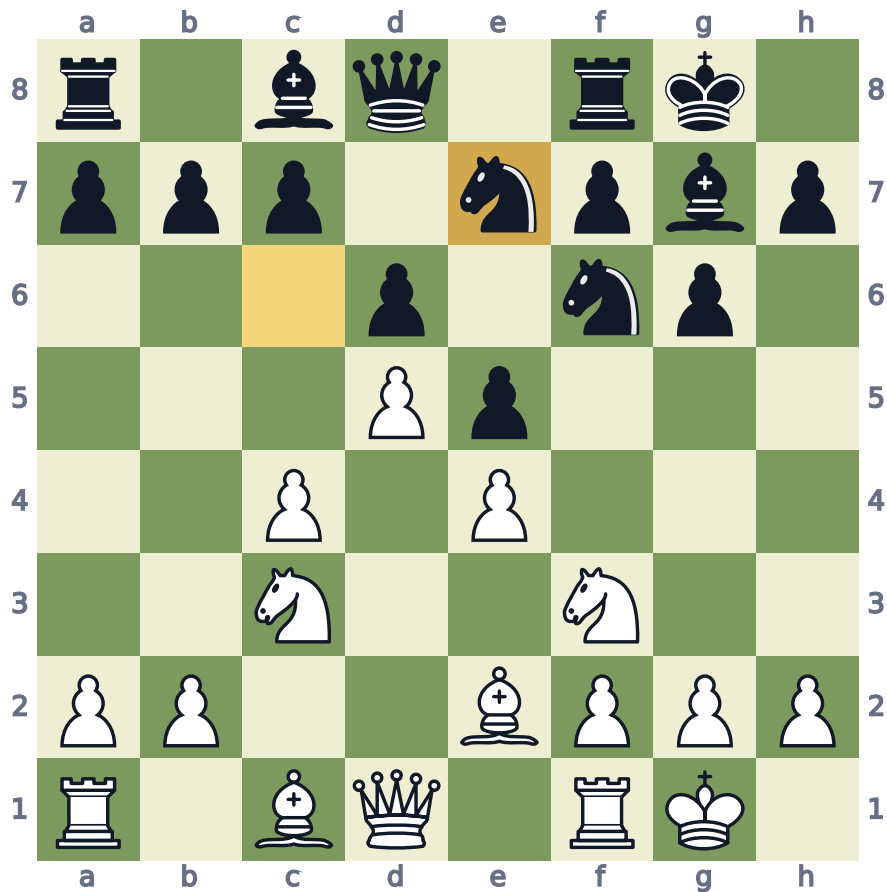
1. Nc3 Ne4 2. Nxe4 Bxe4 3. Qe3 d5 4. O-O Nd7 5. cxd5 exd5 (+0.48 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

After a bishop trade, reorganize development rather than mourning a tempo.

STRUCTURE 16 OF 30

Classical King's Indian



WHITE'S PLAN

Close the center and prepare queenside expansion while tracking ...f5.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The kingside can open rapidly after ...f5 and ...fxe4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

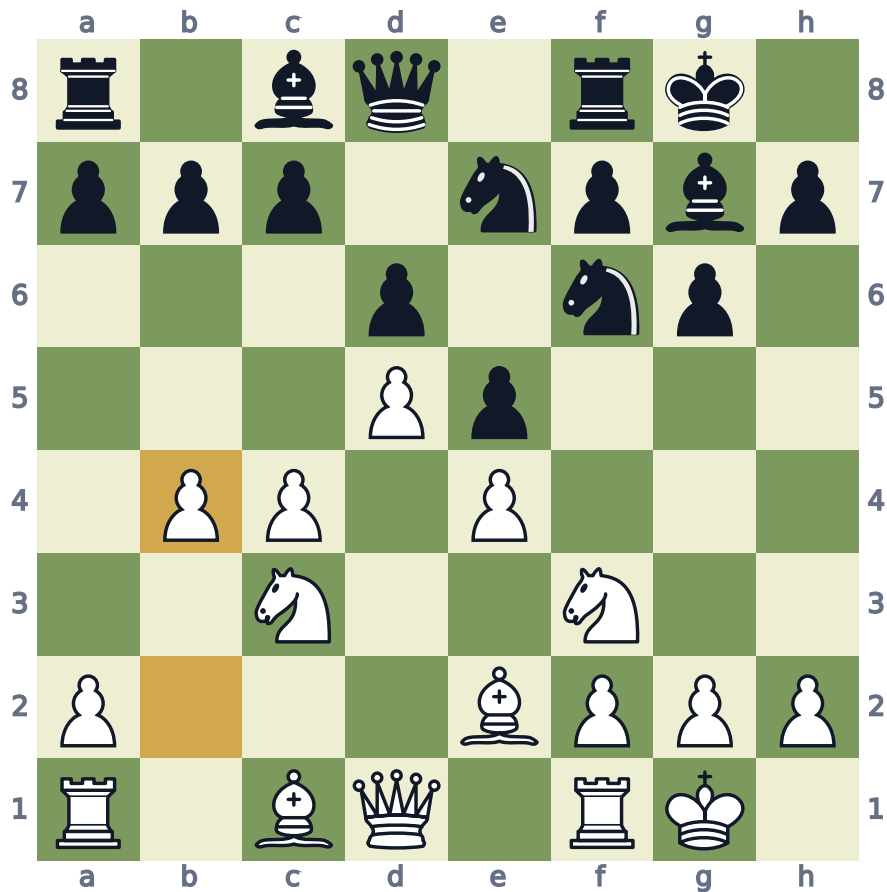
1. b4 a5 2. bxa5 Rxa5 3. a4 Nd7 4. Nd2 Kh8 (+0.76 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

After d5, follow the pawn-chain arrow toward c5.

STRUCTURE 17 OF 30

Bayonet setup



WHITE'S PLAN

Gain queenside space and prepare c5 before Black's attack lands.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

b4 can become a hook for ...a5 or ...c6 if unsupported.

ENGINE SAMPLE

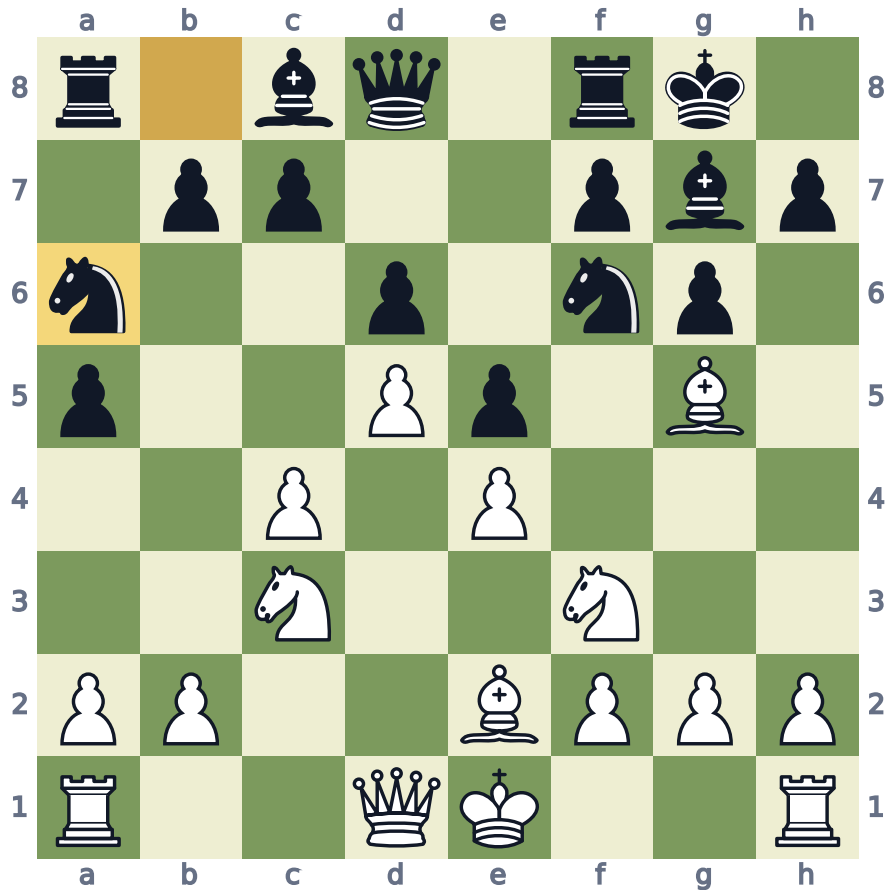
1. Ne8 Nd2 2. a5 bxa5 3. Rxa5 a4 4. Ra8 (+0.77 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

b4 is useful when it accelerates c5, not as decoration.

STRUCTURE 18 OF 30

Petrosian restraint



WHITE'S PLAN

Use Bg5 to slow ...f5 and reduce Black's coordination.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The bishop can be chased and lose tempi if the center opens.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Nd2 h6 2. Be3 Nd7 3. a3 f5 4. f3 Kh7 (+0.81 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

A pin on the f6-knight can delay the kingside break.

STRUCTURE 19 OF 30

Exchange Grunfeld core



WHITE'S PLAN

Build the center, develop with tempo, and protect d4.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The c3 pawn and d4 base can become targets on the long diagonal.

ENGINE SAMPLE

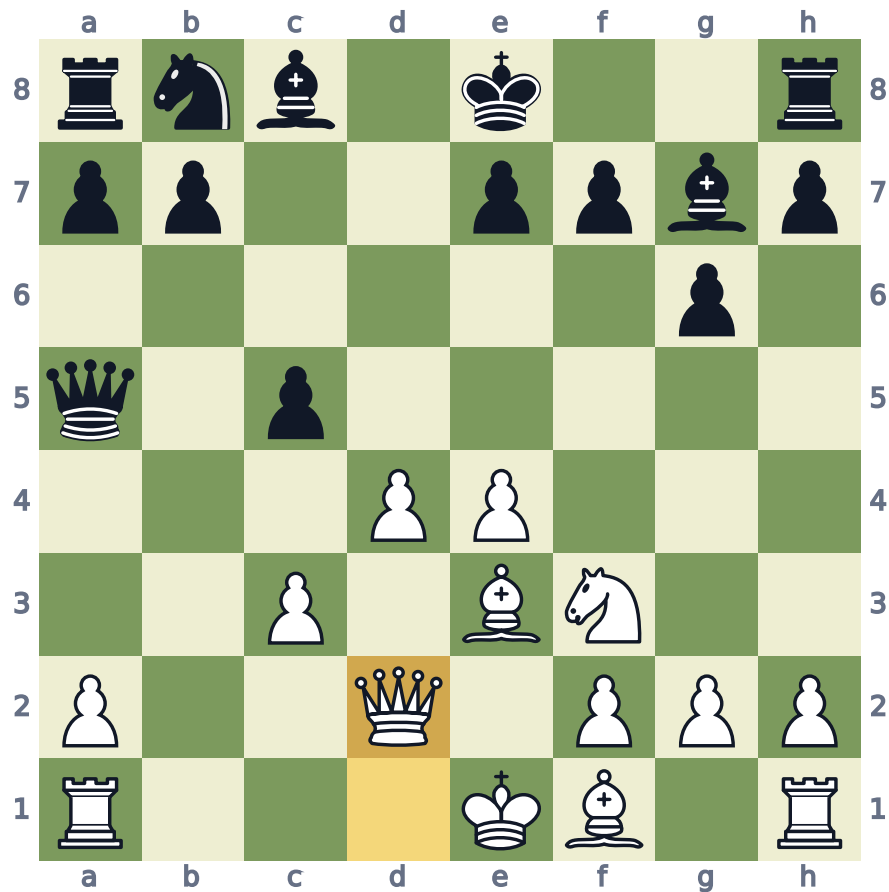
1. Qa5 Bd2 2. Bg4 Qb3 3. O-O Qxb7 4. Nd7 Qa6 5. Qc7 Rc1 (+0.09 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

After ...Nxc3, the b-pawn strengthens d4 but fixes the structure.

STRUCTURE 20 OF 30

Qd2 development



WHITE'S PLAN

Connect the rooks, defend c3, and prepare Rc1 or Be2.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Queen placement can run into ...cxd4 and discovered pressure.

ENGINE SAMPLE

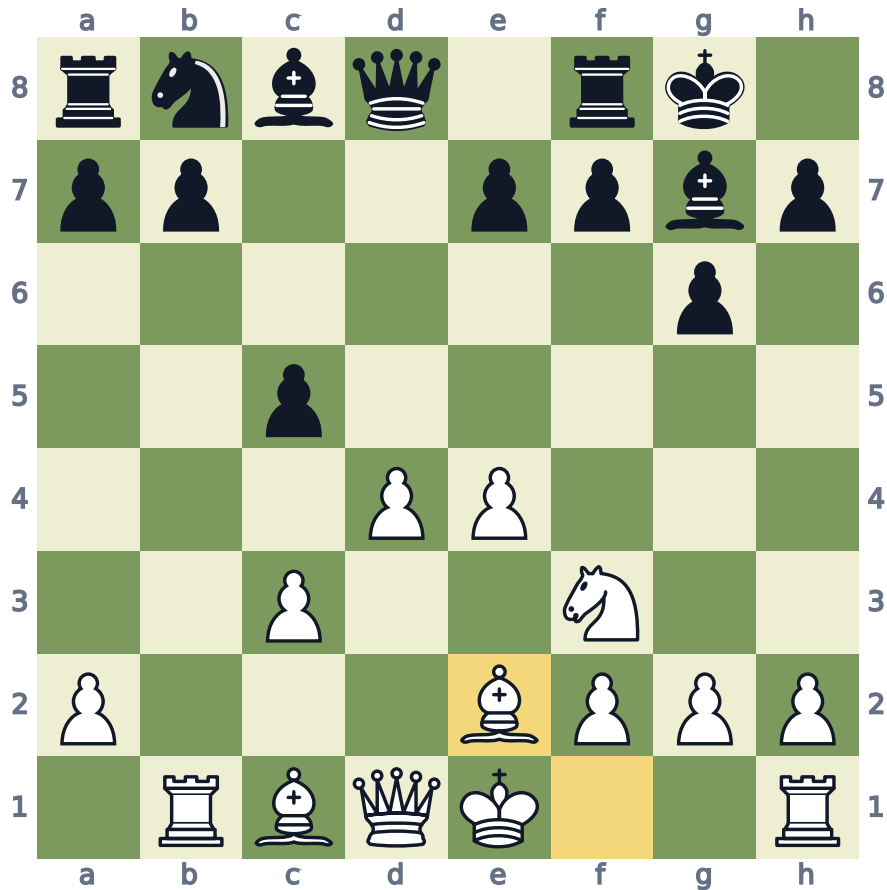
1. Nc6 Rb1 2. cxd4 cxd4 3. O-O Qxa5 4. Nxa5 Bd3 5. Rd8 (+0.24 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Qd2 is useful because it serves development and structure at once.

STRUCTURE 21 OF 30

Rb1 system

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Move the rook off the long diagonal and support queenside expansion.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Rb1 costs a tempo if Black can attack the center immediately.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. cxd4 cxd4 2. Qa5+ Bd2 3. Qxa2 O-O 4. Nc6 (+0.26 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When the a1 rook is a tactical target, Rb1 can be a developing move.

STRUCTURE 22 OF 30

Modern Benoni core



WHITE'S PLAN

Use e4-f4 and prepare e5 while Black seeks queenside counterplay.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The center can be attacked by ...Re8, ...b5, and tactics on e4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

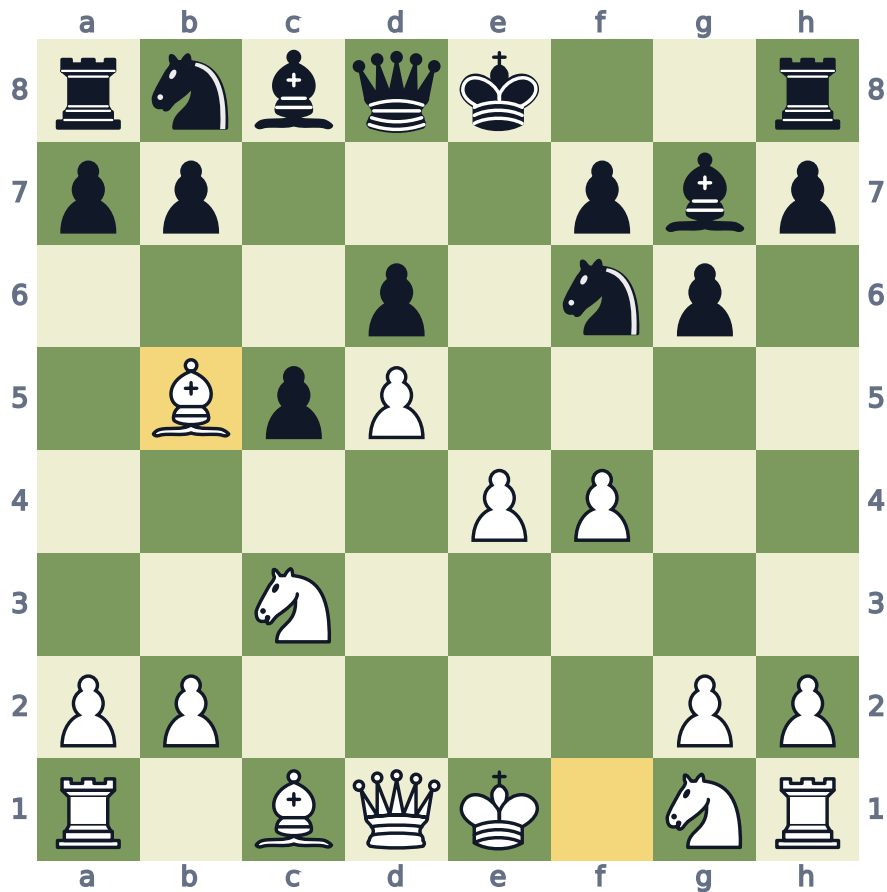
1. Bb5+ Nfd7 2. Be2 Qh4+ 3. g3 Qe7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. O-O Na6 (+0.81 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Space gives a plan, but ...b5 gives Black activity.

STRUCTURE 23 OF 30

Taimanov check



WHITE'S PLAN

Use the check to interfere with Black's development before castling.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

A check without a follow-up can merely improve Black's pieces.

ENGINE SAMPLE

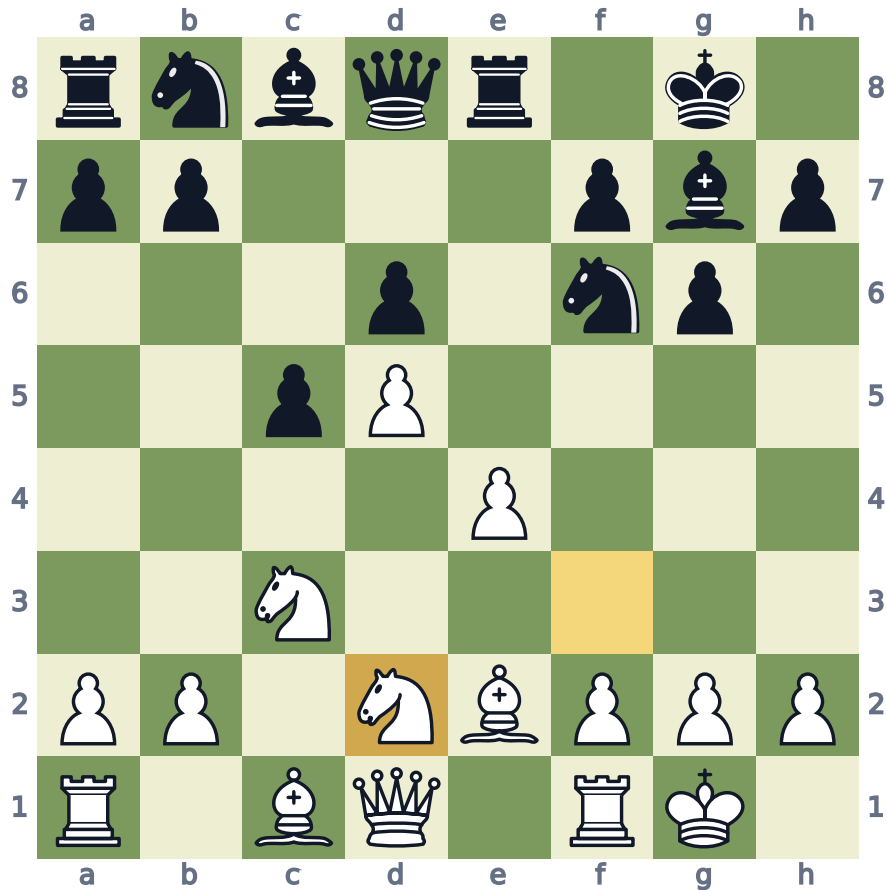
1. Nfd7 Be2 2. Qh4+ g3 3. Qd8 Nf3 4. O-O O-O 5. Na6 g4 (+0.76 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Bb5+ matters because Black's b8 knight has not developed.

STRUCTURE 24 OF 30

Benoni e5 break



WHITE'S PLAN

Support e4 and prepare f3 or Nc4 before driving with e5.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

e5 can leave d5 weak if the pieces cannot follow.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Na6 f3 2. Nc7 a4 3. Nd7 Kh1 4. b6 Nb5 5. Nxb5 Bxb5 (+0.74 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Prepare the break by controlling the square behind the pawn.

STRUCTURE 25 OF 30

Leningrad Dutch



WHITE'S PLAN

Fianchetto, control e4, and prepare d5 or Qc2 depending on ...e5.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Black's ...e5 can arrive with tactical force against d4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

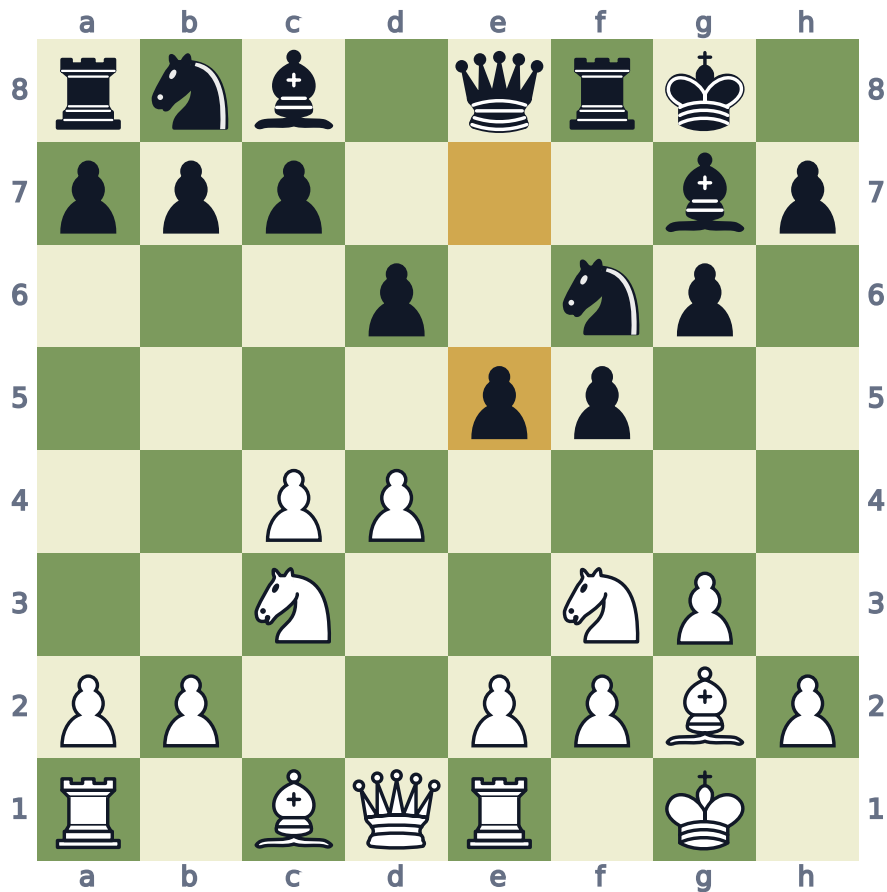
1. c6 Re1 2. Na6 e4 3. fxe4 Nxe4 4. Nxe4 Rxe4 5. Bf5 (+0.66 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against ...g6, finish the mirror fianchetto before central action.

STRUCTURE 26 OF 30

Leningrad ...e5

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Meet the central break with e4, d5, or dxe5 after concrete calculation.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Closing with d5 can give Black a kingside attacking map.

ENGINE SAMPLE

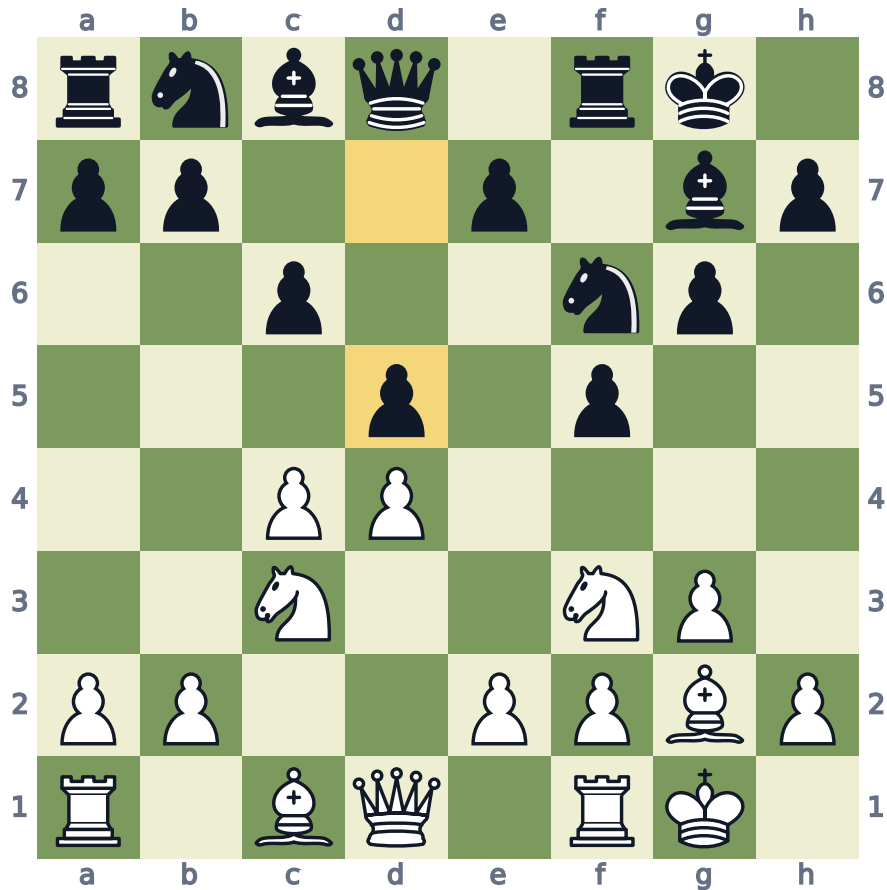
1. dxe5 dxe5 2. e4 fxe4 3. Ng5 Nc6 4. Nd5 Nxd5 5. Qxd5+ Kh8 (+0.52 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

When ...Qe8 appears, assume ...e5 and sometimes ...f4 are coming.

STRUCTURE 27 OF 30

Leningrad ...c6

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Challenge the compact center with Qb3 or cxd5 while retaining flexibility.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

An automatic cxd5 can free the c8 bishop.

ENGINE SAMPLE

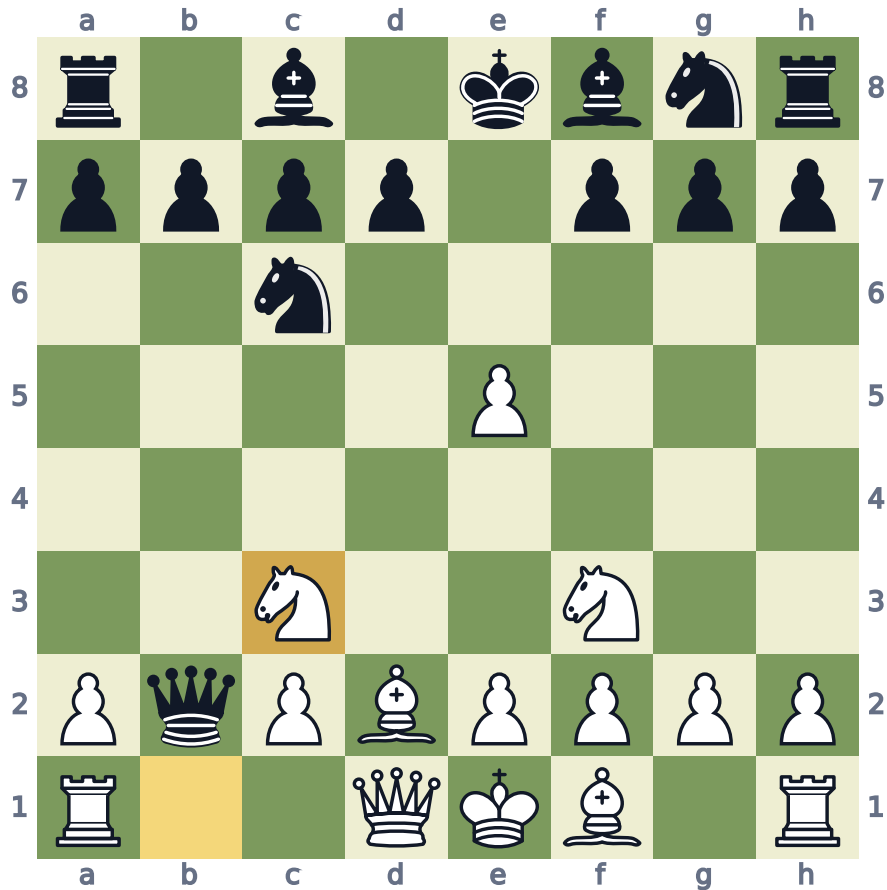
1. cxd5 cxd5 2. Bf4 Nc6 3. Rc1 h6 4. Ne5 g5 5. Nxc6 bxc6 (+0.82 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

...c6 and ...d5 creates a Stonewall-like center with a fianchetto.

STRUCTURE 28 OF 30

Englund Gambit



WHITE'S PLAN

Develop with tempo and be ready to return the pawn to trap or displace the queen.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The b2-pawn is poisoned only if White knows the follow-up.

ENGINE SAMPLE

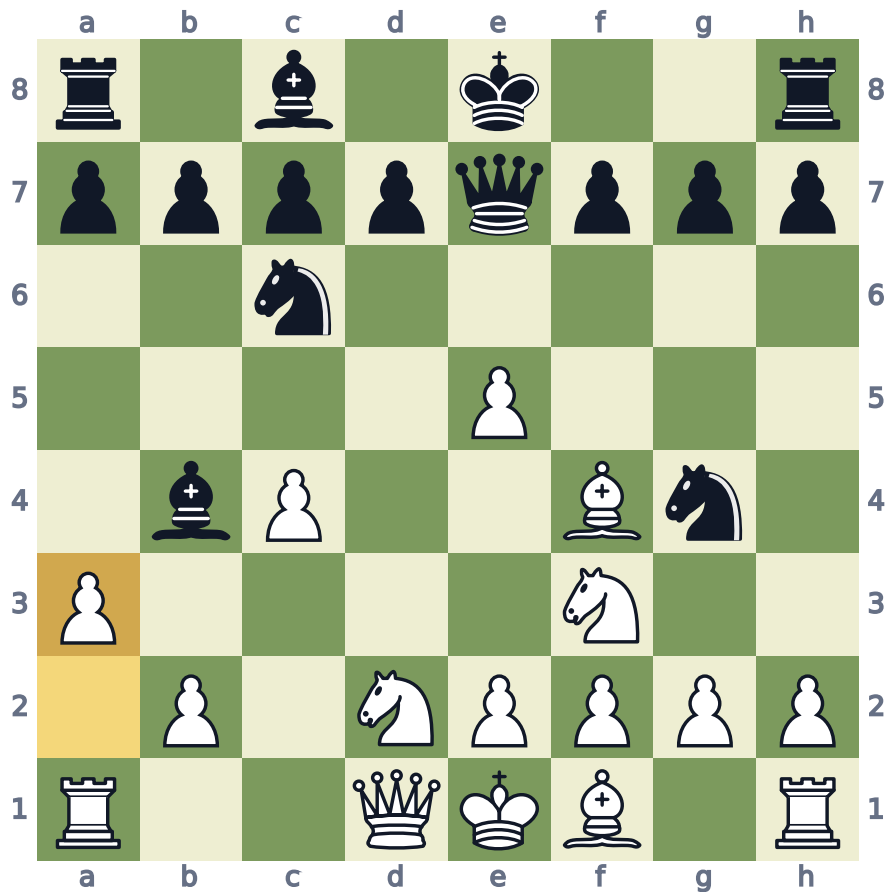
1. Bb4 Rb1 2. Qa3 Nd5 3. Bxd2+ Qxd2 4. Kd8 e4 5. Qxa2 Qg5+ (+1.83 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Meet queen checks first; material comes second.

STRUCTURE 29 OF 30

Budapest Gambit



WHITE'S PLAN

Develop, meet the check, and return e5 if it completes development.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

Trying to cling to e5 can leave the king in the center.

ENGINE SAMPLE

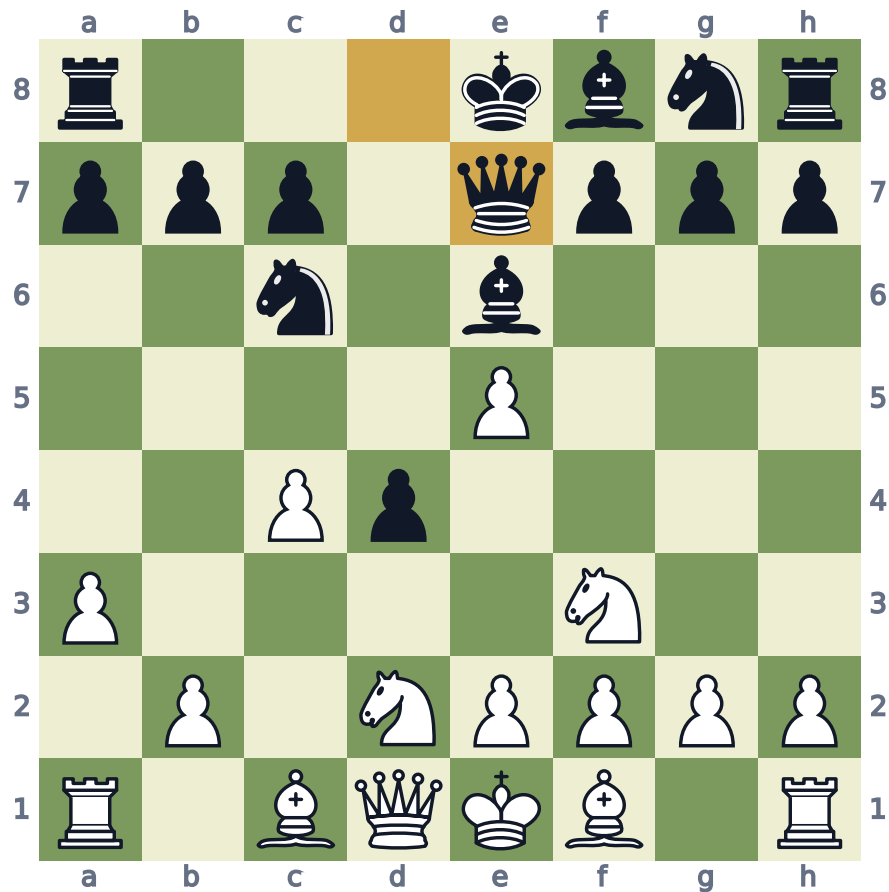
1. Bxd2+ Qxd2 2. O-O Rc1 3. Ngxe5 Nxe5 4. Nxe5 c5 5. Rd8 e4 (+0.59 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Bf4 protects e5 while developing; Nbd2 answers the check safely.

STRUCTURE 30 OF 30

Albin Countergambit



WHITE'S PLAN

Blockade d4 and complete development before trying to win the pawn.

BLACK'S RESOURCE

The advanced d4-pawn supports tactical checks and promotion tricks.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. b4 Bg4 2. g3 Nxe5 3. Nxe5 Qxe5 4. h3 d3 5. hxg4 Qxa1 (+1.55 for White (White is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Stop the passer, then attack it.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.